

current value, not the value at maturity or the value on the date you're fully vested. You should receive statements showing the current value of your accounts from your employer for retirement accounts and from your broker for bonds. The human resources department where you work can help you determine the current value of your company stock options if you're lucky enough to have them.

List only those life insurance policies that have a cash value. Most life insurance policies are provided by employers and are term policies good only for the time you're employed by that company. These are not considered assets. If you've purchased cash-value life insurance from an agent and you're unsure of the current cash value, she should be able to help you determine the amount you would get if you cashed it in today. Use that amount for your net worth statement.

For cars and other vehicles, use the Kelley Blue Book value, which is the estimated price the car would sell for if sold privately to another consumer or to a car dealer. You can look up Kelley Blue Book values at the library or online at www.kbb.com. For all other assets, use your best estimate of the fair market value.

▼ ASSETS

Cash Equivalents	Investments	Retirement Funds	Real Estate
Bank and money market accounts	Stocks, bonds, mutual funds	401(k)/pension funds	House
CDs	Savings bonds	IRAs	Land
Cash on hand	Stock options	Small-business plans	Rental property
Personal property	Household goods	Money owed you	Other assets
Vehicles	Furnishings	Rents due you	Life insurance
Campers and RVs	Jewelry and furs	Rental deposits	Privately owned business
Boats	Electronic equipment	Utility deposits	

Now you've listed everything you own that has a monetary value, but the total is not a true representation of your financial worth. It doesn't take into account the money you may owe banks or finance companies before you really own some of your assets—such as your house or car, for example. It also doesn't yet take into account the money that you owe to other creditors. These are called your liabilities.